VITALITY 14

Melanotan II

Lab-made ring-shaped 7-amino-acid peptide modelled on alpha-melanocyte-stimulating hormone



CLASS Peptide

STUDIED FOR Erections, skin tanning

HUMAN EVIDENCE Tiny studies; case reports

US STATUS Not FDA approved; "research use only"

STUDIED FOR

- **Erections** — HUMAN
- **Skin darkening** — HUMAN

Later reports are mostly of harm. Case reports describe melanoma, priapism, muscle breakdown and a brain-swelling syndrome. Single cases cannot show cause.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Melanotan II → Melanocortin rec. → Brain and skin → Erections, tanning

- **Activates melanocortin receptors,** like natural alpha-MSH
- **Darkened skin** and caused spontaneous erections in its first human test
- **In people,** the mechanism for erections is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CASE REPORTS
LEVEL 2 OF 5

- 3 small studies, 3 to 10 men, 1996 to 2000
- No larger trial published
- Serious harms described in case reports

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Product purity and dose
- Drug interactions

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE Not established in people

ROUTES STUDIED Injection under the skin (1990s studies)

PHARMACOKINETICS Limited human data

SOLD AS Not approved; sold labelled "research use only"

MONITORED IN TRIALS Erections, skin colour, side effects

SPORT (WADA) Not named; S0 may cover it (no WADA ruling)

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; Category 2 nomination withdrawn
FDA	"Research use" labels do not permit human sale
TGA	Prescription-only (Schedule 4) in Australia
WADA	Not named; S0 may cover it

REFERENCES

1. Wessells et al., J Urol, Melanotan II in psychogenic ED, Aug 1998
2. FDA, bulk drug substances with significant safety risks (Category 2), Apr 2026
3. Habbema et al., Int J Dermatol, melanotan review, Oct 2017

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